Mehdi Eskandari-Ghadi

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EDUCATION

Civil Engineering Ph.D. (GPA 4.0) **Boulder, CO**
Engineering Science Focus 2016 – 2021
University of Colorado Boulder

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming	Python, TypeScript/JavaScript, VBA, MATLAB, AutoLISP
Platforms & Data	Palantir Foundry (Ontology, Pipeline Builder, Workshop, OSDK, AIP), Spark, Polars, Pandas
Engineering	AutoCAD, PLSCADD, L-PILE, ABAQUS/LS-DYNA
Standards & Tools	NESC, GO-95, FERC-881, Git, Microsoft Office Suite, LaTeX

ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

Reliability & Standards Solutions Engineer II **Jan 2025 – Present**
PacifiCorp

- Applied full-stack TypeScript and Python engineering to end-to-end design, build, and deploy a Foundry-based data management system, migrating prototype FERC-881 line-rating and FAC-008 equipment-rating business logic into the company's production solution - concurrent to testing and production adoption - from backend pipelines through user-facing UIs - covering audit preparation, interdepartmental data collection, and queue-based processing pipelines.
- Built a Foundry-based ecosystem, spanning an Ontology with 100+ Actions and Functions and 30+ Pipeline Builder pipelines, to manage transmission facility and equipment records, track record modifications, and compute granular, operations-scale rating calculations, with external system interfacing delivered through automations, map interfaces, graphs, and other data solution UI elements; owned end-to-end UX design for the system via Foundry Workshop, continuously identifying friction points and iterating on layout and information architecture to keep complex, multi-source engineering workflows simple and intuitive for end users.
- Directed AI coding agents with repository and Foundry Ontology access to write and edit functions, entire features, and React-based custom Workshop widgets through a full commit, tag, and pull-request workflow, coordinating agent-driven changes across multiple interdependent repositories while maintaining version and compatibility consistency.
- Built a reusable Python report-processing library and used it to power an LLM-based reporting pipeline via Palantir AIP, generating narrative reports on system modification changes and their system implications for administrative review and approval.
- Architected a git-inspired version-control framework - a reusable pattern for system analysis lifecycle management within Foundry - supporting cloning, modification, and staged publication of facility analyses through department-specific review checkpoints, with automated resource tracking and validation.
- Leveraging Spark and Polars, designed backend Python data pipelines to ingest, parse, and remediate enterprise-scale, imperfect legacy data spanning multiple database and spreadsheet sources, automating data cleanup and multi-source merging to reconcile records to production quality standards.
- Utilized knowledge of physics and numerical methods to build a reusable Python rating-calculation library implementing IEEE-compliant thermal rating models, solving the nonlinear ordinary-differential heat balance (solar heat gain, convective cooling, radiative heat loss, conductor resistance) through Runge-Kutta forward integration and Newton-Raphson inverse root-finding, vectorized at scale for static, dynamic, and transient line and equipment ratings within the platform.
- Applied VBA/Excel programming skills alongside IEEE equipment-rating knowledge to design and build a streamlined, user-friendly FAC-008 substation equipment rating tool from scratch, computing normal and emergency ratings and ranking limiting elements for substation equipment - including breakers, switches, capacitors, reactors, buses, jumpers, and transformers - from company standards and nameplate specifications.
- Applied geometric and spatial analysis methods to compute mutual-impedance candidate pairs, line-distance statistics, and line-to-line distance visualizations for parallel transmission corridors, integrated into platform UI graphs.
- Deployed AutoCAD experience and design architecture skills to implement AutoLISP one-line-drawing functionality to parse shape geometries and layer data - identifying transmission facilities and equipment, deducing line segment and equipment configurations, and exporting structured data to reconcile database records with engineering drawings.

Transmission Engineer I/II **Jan 2023 – Jan 2025**
PacifiCorp

- Utilized high-level knowledge of transmission line design to scope new transmission lines in collaboration with other engineering disciplines.

- Utilized in-depth knowledge of PLSCADD, L-PILE, NESC, and GO-95 for design of new power transmission lines and rebuilding/maintenance of existing lines in six states in collaboration with teams of engineers, managers, field crew, and legal.
- Utilized in-depth knowledge of structural engineering and geotechnical engineering for custom-engineered solutions of transmission structures and drilled pier foundations with reference to ASCE, ACI, and FHWA to meet special needs.
- Overhauled the company's transmission structure library from legacy templates into modular, component-based PLS-POLE libraries, and designed a new class of circuit-swap structures for repositioning circuits on a double-circuit extra-high-voltage line with minimal increase to structure size, vetted across engineering and field operations to meet electrical and structural requirements.
- Utilized VBA and Excel programming alongside transmission line rating engineering knowledge to design and build an auditable, automated FERC-881 steady-state line-rating analysis tool from scratch - integrating PLS-CADD structure data, conductor properties, and historical weather data with CIGRE-referenced seasonal rating methodology to compute normal and emergency ratings and critical-span summaries - streamlining grid line data extraction, reducing engineering hours threefold and costs by approx. $1.5M, and initializing the Foundry datasets that the system later grew from.
- Employed excel programming and data analysis skills to develop automated tools for deep foundation design, construction package generation, and transmission pole design aids.
- Utilized transmission engineering knowledge and programming experience to generate company sag-tension standards for tree-wire.
- Designed and reviewed drawings for tubular steel poles and drilled piers to withstand vertical and lateral loads.
- Performed detail-oriented technical review of transmission standards and collaboration in their developments.
- Initiated process improvement pipelines for transmission design processes and documentations.
- Improved company standards and company procedures with detail-oriented reviews/QAQC.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Academic Research

Graduate Research Assistant / Ph.D. Candidate / Postdoctoral Researcher **Jun 2018 – Jan 2023**
University of Colorado Boulder, Boulder, CO

- Collaborated with a team of three senior researchers at the Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory to investigate and develop mechanistic models for subcritical crack growth healing.
- Utilized knowledge of fundamentals of fracture mechanics, fluid transport, and boundary element methods to develop a software that couples fields of mechanics and physics.
- Merged expertise in research, programming, and engineering to investigate multiphysical and multiscale solid-fluid interactions (e.g., adsorption, surface tension, solvation pressure) in porous solids and develop a thermodynamics-poromechanics-based MATLAB software for "adsorption-induced deformation of microporous material".
- Employed technical writing and illustrative skills to author 4 peer-reviewed publications in respected journals of JMPS, IJSS, and EFM.

Talks and Presentations

EMI Virtual Conference 2021 and EMI Conference 2022 **May 2021 and May 2022**

- Applied illustrative and verbal communication skills to deliver presentations titled "A multi-scale theory explaining the initial shrinkage of micro-porous solid upon gas adsorption" and "A Multiphysical Surface-Force Based Fracture Theory for Subcritical Crack Growth in Surface-Reactive Environments", followed by Q&A from engineering and academic audience.
- Received runner up award in the 2021 Student Poster Competition for poster presentation on sorption-induced deformation of porous material.

Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory BES **Sep 2020 – Jan 2023**

- Presented regular scientific presentations on topic of crack propagation to teams of research professionals and senior scientists in the LBNL BES with diverse backgrounds in mechanics, physics, and chemistry.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistantships/Tutoring

Teaching Assistant / Tutor **2014 – 2019**
University of Colorado Boulder, Boulder, CO & University of Tehran, Tehran, Iran

- Presented class lectures and laboratory teaching sessions, held office hours and exam preparation sessions, prepared and graded exams and homework question sets, for courses of Advanced mechanics of materials and Dynamics.
- Tutored students for FE exam with 100% success rate.
- Tailored teaching approach specific to different student learning styles and utilized CAD skills to enhance visualization and understanding.

- Held office hours and graded homework, quizzes, and class projects for Structural Analysis II and Hydraulics of open channels as a Teaching Assistant at the University of Tehran, Fall 2014 and Fall 2015.

LEADERSHIP ROLES

Mentorship

Research Mentor **Jan 2022 – Jan 2023**

University of Colorado Boulder, Boulder, CO

- Trained new Ph.D. students on fundamentals of mechanics, written and oral skills, and technical research.
- Guided a research trainee through the modeling and simulation of beam bending in humidity actuators.

President/Co-president — Persian Student Organization, Boulder, CO **Aug 2018 – May 2019**

University of Colorado Boulder, Boulder, CO

- Proposed, secured funding, planned, and oversaw student events in collaboration with professionals from industry and academia, local businesses, and non-profit organizations.